



BRECKSVILLE-BROADVIEW HTS.
CITY SCHOOL DISTRICT

"where fine education is a heritage"

Book	Policy Manual
Section	10/02/2019
Title	INTERSCHOLASTIC ATHLETICS
Code	po2431
Status	First Reading
Adopted	July 23, 2007
Last Revised	June 26, 2017

2431 - **INTERSCHOLASTIC ATHLETICS**

The Board of Education recognizes the value to the students of the District and to the community of a program of interscholastic athletics for students as an integral part of the total school experience.

The program should foster the growth of school loyalty within the student body as a whole and stimulate community interest in athletics.

The game activities and practice sessions should provide many opportunities to teach the values of competition and good sportsmanship.

The program of interscholastic athletics should provide students the opportunity to exercise and test their athletic abilities in a context greater and more varied than that which can be offered by a school or the School District alone. It should also offer an opportunity for career and educational development.

For purposes of this policy, the program of interscholastic athletics shall include all activities relating to competitive sport contests, games, events, or sport exhibitions involving individual students or teams of students of this District with those of another district.

The Board shall determine the standards of eligibility to be met by all students participating in the interscholastic program. Such standards shall require that each student be in good physical condition, be free of injury, and have fully recovered from illness before participating in any interscholastic athletic event. No student may practice or compete in interscholastic athletics until the student submits a form signed by his/her parent or guardian, or by a person having care or charge of the student, affirming that each has received a concussion and head injury information sheet as prepared by the Ohio Department of Health. See Form 2431 F1 and Form 2431 F2.

In addition to the eligibility requirements established by the Ohio High School Athletic Association, to be eligible for any interscholastic extra-curricular activity, a student must have maintained at least a 1.50 grade-point average for the grading period prior to the grading period in which s/he wishes to participate.

Students educated at home or enrolled in a nonpublic school who are permitted to participate on a District interscholastic team must fulfill the same academic, nonacademic, and financial requirements as any other participant. See Policy 9270.

If a student who becomes ineligible under these standards improves his/her grade point average during the current grading period to meet the eligibility standard, s/he may be reinstated at the beginning of the next grading period.

Restoration of an "Incomplete" Grade

If a student's failure to meet the academic eligibility requirements is due to an "incomplete" grade given in one or more courses which the student was taking during the grading period in question, the student may have his/her eligibility restored once the "incomplete" has been changed to a passing letter grade provided:

1. the failure to complete the required coursework during the grading period was due to calamity day(s), family tragedy, or illness or accident as verified by a physician; and
2. the "incomplete" was given in accordance with Board of Education grading policies and procedures and is applicable to all students in the school; and
3. the previously scheduled work and/or exams is/are completed within the time period provided in Board policy for completing work required to convert an "incomplete" into a letter grade; and
4. there is no evidence that the "incomplete" was given in order to afford the student extended time in order to provide the student tutoring or other educational services simply to avoid a failing grade.

Specific documentation of criteria listed above (Items A-D) must be submitted to the Ohio High School Athletic Association (OHSAA) (See AG 2431) in order to be considered by the Executive Director for such a ruling.

[DRAFTING NOTE: This exception only applies where an "incomplete" has been issued and not a letter grade that is subsequently changed as a result of the extended time/additional work. In order to be considered for this exception, specific documentation as listed in OHSAA Bylaw 4-4-1 (See AG 2431) must be provided to the OHSAA. The student may have his/her eligibility restored by the Executive Director's office once the "incomplete" has been changed to a passing letter grade. If the District does NOT have a Board Policy on the Restoration of an Incomplete to a Grade or did not have a policy when this exception was requested, the student shall not be able to avail him/herself of this exception.]

These same eligibility standards shall apply to all other co-curricular and extra-curricular activities sponsored by the District. (See Policy 2430).

Students identified as disabled under R.C. 3323 and the IDEA are subject to the eligibility standards established by this policy unless specifically exempted by the express terms of their individualized education program (IEP). An IEP can specify the criteria by which a grade will be determined for (a) course(s), given the student's individualized disability.

Since the primary purpose of the athletic program is to enhance the education of participating students as indicated in this policy, the Board places priority on student participation and the values of good sportsmanship and fair play.

No student shall be excused from a class or supervised study for an extended period of time to participate in interscholastic athletics.

The Board further directs that only those students may participate in the program of interscholastic athletics who have demonstrated good citizenship and responsibility and comply with the student code of conduct.

The Superintendent shall develop appropriate administrative guidelines for the operation of the Athletic Program and a Code of Conduct for those who participate.

In order to minimize health and safety risks to student-athletes and maintain ethical standards, school personnel, coaches, athletic trainers, and lay coaches shall not dispense, supply, recommend, or permit the use of any drug, medication, or food supplement solely for performance-enhancing purposes. The Superintendent shall cause to be posted in all locker rooms in buildings that include students in any grade higher than the sixth grade, the following:

"Warning: Improper use of anabolic steroids may cause serious or fatal health problems, such as heart disease, stroke, cancer, growth deformities, infertility, personality changes, severe acne, and baldness. Possession, sale, or use of anabolic steroids without a valid prescription is a crime punishable by a fine and imprisonment."

Students will be further informed that participation in interscholastic sports is a privilege and not a right, and that they may be prohibited from all or part of their participation in such activities by authorized school personnel without further notice, hearing and/or appeal rights (See Policy 5610.05 - Prohibition From Extra-Curricular Activities).

In order to support the High School Athletic Association's program to strengthen sportsmanship, ethics, and integrity, the Board commits itself to:

- A. adopt policies (upon recommendation of the administration) which reflect the District's educational objectives and promote the ideals of good sportsmanship, ethics, and integrity;
- B. establish standards for athletic participation which reinforce the concept that athletic activities are a privilege, not a right;

- C. attend and enjoy school athletic activities, serving as a positive role model and expecting the same from parents, fans, participants, coaches, and other school personnel;
- D. support and recognize participants, coaches, school administrators, and fans who display good sportsmanship;
- E. recognize the value of school athletic activities as a vital part of education.

No student will be denied the opportunity to participate in interscholastic athletics offered by a school in the District because the student has or is participating in college credit plus program as long as the student fulfills all academic, nonacademic and financial requirements.

Revised 10/22/07

Revised 12/15/08

Revised 5/28/09

Revised 7/22/13

Revised 3/17/14

Revised 6/26/17

© Neola ~~2017~~ **2019**

Legal

R.C. 2305.23, 2305.231, 3313.53, 3313.535, 3313.539, 3313.5311, 3313.5312

R.C. 3313.5341, 3313.752, 3315.062

Ohio High School Athletic Association

